

The BlackBerry push technologies were so successful that the rest of the industry simply copied RIM and added similar functionality to their own products. Microsoft added push support to Exchange Server and its Windows Mobile product line in 2007, as did Apple, tentatively, with the first iPhone. Over the intervening years, Apple broadened the iPhone's support of push. Today, no modern smart phone platform would be complete without push support, not just for email, but also for contacts and calendar. And while Windows Phone does support pre-push technologies, it is optimized for push-based email support.

## Accounts and email

Creating and properly configuring a Windows Live ID is key to the Windows Phone experience. When you log on to your phone with this ID, you're creating an account on the phone. And this Windows Live, based account is considered your primary account because it interacts with a variety of web-based services that are central to Windows Phone and, perhaps more important, unique to this ID. Web services that can only be connected to your primary account include your Messenger social feed (which populates the What's New lists in the People and Pictures hubs), Xbox Live account, Marketplace account (for Zune-based content as well as apps and games), Zune Pass subscription, OneNote note-syncing, Windows Live photo posting, Find My Phone, and more.

This primary account is also used for contacts sync with the People hub, calendar sync with the Calendar app, and, if you enable it explicitly, email as well. These services are available via a number of account types, not just your primary account. So depending on the type(s) of accounts you've configured, you may have an interesting mix of services providing email, contacts, and calendar data to your phone.

Email is, perhaps, the most basic of these services because it is the most common among the different account types. In fact, when you examine these account types, you'll see that all of them offer email except Facebook. Some of them, in fact, offer only email. And when you combine that fact with another interesting Windows Phone tidbit, that you can have multiple accounts of the same type configured on one phone, you can see that it's possible that you could have an awful lot of email happening on that little device. So it's a good idea to get it right.

Before continuing, we'll take a quick look at the account types you can configure in the Email & Accounts settings interface for email. These include: